

October 09th, 2026
Week 41
Volume 282, Issue 1256

QUOTE
of the
WEEK

"He that can have patience, can have what he will."

- Benjamin Franklin

-- MARKET COMMENTARY --

Click "Ctrl" + below to launch the GMS Weekly Summary Podcast



Highlights:

- **Hormuz Tightens**

- **Crude Reverses**

- **Freight Slips**

- **Owners Hold**

Scan to download
/ view the Weekly
on the GMS App!



OWNERS HOLD ALL THE CARDS

Last week, Chattogram reclaimed first place on the conventional recycling board. This week, its leading bid has been left looking for something to buy. Across the sub-continent, the familiar imbalance persists: end buyers are available, prices remain broadly intact, and the ships needed to turn both into transactions are still earning money elsewhere. The market has not lost its appetite. It has simply run short of willing sellers.

The Strait of Hormuz supplied another reminder that the recovery in Gulf shipping remains fragile. Renewed tanker attacks have disrupted crude movements and revived concerns over passage, security and insurance. Washington's announcement that it would refrain from further strikes against Iran before the November 3 midterm elections provided some immediate relief, although the U.S. blockade remains in place. The threat of further disruption has not disappeared, and shipowners continue to navigate a Gulf where commercial passage carries more than the usual risks.

Oil responded with another sharp reversal. Brent climbed above USD 105 per barrel on Thursday as attacks intensified, before retreating toward USD 103 on Friday following Washington's announcement. WTI traded around USD 90. The immediate fear of escalation may have eased, but the premium attached to moving energy through the Gulf remains firmly embedded. Higher bunker costs and altered trading patterns continue to complicate voyage economics, without necessarily encouraging owners to consider recycling.

Dry freight, meanwhile, has finally shown a more consistent retreat. The Baltic Dry Index eased from 3,148 on October 2 to 2,973 on Thursday, October 8, with Capesizes slipping to 4,512 while Panamax and Supramaxes held at 2,410 and 1,808 respectively. Larger bulkers have surrendered more ground, but the smaller segments remain comparatively resilient. Earnings are cooling, yet not sufficiently to trigger the broader retirement decisions that recyclers have been awaiting. A softer freight market is welcome. A sufficiently weak one remains elusive.

The macro picture offered little common direction. India's Reserve Bank raised its policy rate to 5.50%, reflecting persistent inflationary pressure, while Bangladesh's September CPI edged higher to 8.34%. Pakistan's inflation eased to 10.26%, and Turkey's fell below 30% to 29.73%. Domestic steel markets remain uneven, with Indian and Pakistani plate recording modest gains while Bangladesh continues to struggle with sluggish local demand. None of these developments has materially altered the underlying shortage of available recycling candidates.

At the beaches, previously committed vessels continue to arrive and deliver across Alang, Chattogram and Gadani, providing work for the yards without meaningfully replenishing the next sales cycle. Bangladesh retains its conventional pricing lead, Pakistan remains competitive without August's urgency, and India continues to seek stronger value from specialist and non-ferrous-rich units. Turkey has moved modestly lower. Across all four destinations, buying interest remains considerably healthier than fresh transactional activity.

The final quarter is therefore developing into a contest of patience. Recyclers have the capacity and willingness to buy, but owners still have freight earnings, second-hand alternatives and time on their side. Unless those alternatives weaken materially, the long-awaited increase in recycling supply may continue slipping toward 2027. The yards are ready, the bids are waiting, and the decision remains firmly with the owners. For now, they hold all the cards.

GMS market rankings / pricing for week 41 of 2026 are on Page 5.

BANGLADESH



CHATTOGRAM'S BID OUTRUNS SUPPLY

Appetite Holds.

Chattogram enters another week at the top of the conventional recycling board, although the stronger buying position has yet to translate into a meaningful increase in fresh transactions. Demand for suitable dry, tanker and container tonnage remains healthy, with several recyclers prepared to compete for workable candidates. The challenge continues to be availability rather than appetite. Freight earnings and second-hand values are keeping potential sellers on the sidelines, leaving buyers with little opportunity to convert their interest into concluded business.

Steel Slumbers.

The domestic steel market has offered little encouragement. Demand for finished products remains subdued, with local mills and stockists continuing to exercise caution. Plate prices remained unchanged at BDT 64,000 per ton, approximately USD 522.24 per ton, throughout the week. September inflation edged higher to 8.34% from 8.26% in August, adding to the pressure on an already cautious domestic market. Despite these headwinds, vessel indications remain firm at USD 510/LDT for dry bulk, USD 530/LDT for tankers and USD 540/LDT for containers. The resilience of these levels reflects continuing yard requirements and the scarcity of available candidates rather than any improvement in underlying steel fundamentals.

Dryness Beckons.

Physical activity has continued, with the 2,398 LDT tanker Petrova delivered on October 9, followed by the 911 LDT general cargo vessel Pacific Leader on October 6. The 11,304 LDT Ro-Ro vessel Haku was delivered October 3, while Merc and Phil also completed deliveries earlier in the month. These movements have kept the waterfront occupied, although much of the tonnage was secured during earlier buying periods.

Attention is gradually turning toward the approaching dry season, when improved operating conditions could support local steel demand and yard productivity. Whether that seasonal improvement translates into stronger purchasing activity will depend on both domestic consumption and the willingness of owners to release tonnage. For now, Chattogram has the strongest conventional bid in the sub-continent. What it lacks is a steady supply of ships against which to deploy it.

NO MARKET SALES REPORTED

INDIA



ALANG CHARTS ITS OWN COURSE

Alang continues to navigate a different commercial course from its sub-continent competitors. With Bangladesh and Pakistan maintaining stronger conventional indications, Indian recyclers remain selective in their pursuit of standard dry and tanker candidates. Their greater interest continues to lie in LNG carriers, reefers, passenger vessels and other specialised units carrying attractive non-ferrous content. These ships command valuations beyond the ordinary steel-based pricing structure and offer Alang opportunities that are not always available to competing destinations.

Specialists First.

Domestic steel has provided some support, despite a modest retreat toward the end of the week. Alang plate advanced from INR 42,700 per ton on October 3 to INR 42,900 during the week before settling at INR 42,600 on Friday, approximately USD 440.90 per ton. This remains above last week's closing level and provides a slightly stronger foundation for recyclers. The Reserve Bank of India's decision to raise its policy repo rate by 25 basis points to 5.50%, however, introduces a further consideration for financing and domestic steel consumption. Stronger plate values help, but higher borrowing costs and competition from neighbouring destinations continue to restrain conventional purchasing.

Plate Improves.

Activity at Alang has continued with several deliveries, including the 1,226 LDT fishing vessel EVS on October 9, the 10,068 LDT oil tanker Right on October 7, and the 9,886 LDT bulker Enisey on October 6. The yards are receiving tonnage, but the market for fresh candidates remains selective. Conventional GMS indications consequently hold at USD 465/LDT for dry bulk, USD 485/LDT for tankers and USD 495/LDT for containers.

Value Prevails.

India's competitive advantage remains firmly vessel-specific. While its neighbours contest the conventional market at higher levels, Alang continues to find its better opportunities in ships where material composition, specialist handling requirements and compliance considerations carry greater weight than the standard price board. The conventional competition remains difficult. The specialist market offers a course of its own.

NO MARKET SALES REPORTED



GADANI WAITS WITHOUT WAVERING

Demand Endures.

Gadani remains firmly positioned behind Bangladesh on the conventional recycling board, with buying interest continuing despite the scarcity of fresh candidates. The urgency that characterised August has moderated as previously secured vessels have gradually entered the yards, easing immediate requirements. Nevertheless, recyclers remain receptive to suitable tonnage and are prepared to compete when opportunities arise. The absence of new business reflects the shortage of available ships more than any meaningful withdrawal of demand.

Steel Edges.

Domestic steel has shown a modest improvement, with plate advancing from PKR 195,000 per ton to PKR 196,000 on October 9, equivalent to approximately USD 705.80 per ton. The Pakistani Rupee remains relatively stable against the Dollar, while September inflation eased to 10.26% from 11.1% in August. Although these developments provide some support, local steel demand continues to face a cautious environment, limiting the scope for a stronger recovery in vessel pricing. GMS indications remain unchanged at USD 500/LDT for dry bulk, USD 520/LDT for tankers and USD 530/LDT for containers.

Patience Prevails.

The 5,688 LDT bulker Lina F was delivered on October 2, while the 7,381 LDT Portland 11 and 5,143 LDT Maestro remain among the more recent arrivals at Gadani. These units continue to provide physical activity, although fresh buying opportunities remain few and far between.

Pakistan enters the remainder of October with a more measured but still competitive approach. Recyclers have little incentive to pursue marginal opportunities at inflated levels while domestic steel consumption remains uncertain. Yet suitable ships can still attract meaningful attention when owners are prepared to negotiate. Gadani may no longer be setting the pace, but its appetite has not vanished. The buyers remain in place. The next move belongs to the sellers.

NO MARKET SALES REPORTED

TURKEY



ALIAGA TRIMS ITS SAILS

Aliaga has edged lower this week as softer steel and scrap-market sentiment weighs on recycling indications. Dry bulk levels have eased to USD 290/LDT, tankers to USD 300-310/LDT and containers to USD 320/LDT, reversing part of the modest improvement seen during September. Domestic mills remain cautious in their purchasing, with weak finished-steel demand offering little incentive to chase imported scrap or higher-priced recycling candidates.

Prices Retreat.

Turkey's annual inflation fell to 29.73% in September from 31.51% in August, dropping below 30% for the first time in several years. The improvement provides some macroeconomic relief, although persistent currency weakness and elevated financing costs continue to challenge purchasing power. The Turkish Lira remains under pressure against the Dollar, limiting the benefit of lower domestic inflation for internationally priced vessel transactions.

Inflation Eases.

Aliaga continues to operate within its established commercial niche, where geography, proximity to European markets, vessel suitability and applicable environmental requirements can outweigh the substantial pricing gap with the sub-continent. The latest adjustment reflects weaker domestic fundamentals rather than a fundamental change in Turkey's position within global recycling. The board has been trimmed. The market's distinctive role remains intact.

Niche Holds.

NO MARKET SALES REPORTED

GMS Weekly - Market Rankings

For Week 41 of 2026, GMS Market Rankings / Vessel indications are as below.

Rank	Location	Sentiment	Dry Bulk USD / LDT	Tankers USD / LDT	Containers USD / LDT
1	Bangladesh	Steady	510 / LDT	530 / LDT	540 / LDT
2	Pakistan	Steady	500 / LDT	520 / LDT	530 / LDT
3	India	Steady	465 / LDT	485 / LDT	495 / LDT
4	Turkey	Softening	290 / LDT	300-310 / LDT	320 / LDT

DID YOU KNOW?

- **69.16 million tonnes of steel** recovered through ship recycling at Alang is equivalent in weight to approximately **31.7 million empty 20-foot shipping containers**. Placed end to end, they would stretch nearly 192,000 km, almost halfway to the Moon.
- **44.4 billion kWh of energy** estimated to have been saved through ship recycling at Alang could fully charge approximately **740 million electric car batteries** with a capacity of 60 kWh each, excluding charging losses.
- **Over 100 million tonnes of iron ore extraction** estimated to have been avoided through ship recycling at Alang could fill approximately **1.4 million railway ore wagons**. Connected end to end, they would form a train stretching nearly 14,800 km, more than one-third of the way around the Earth.

IMPORTANT DATES

INDIA	
BANK HOLIDAYS	DELIVERY TIDES
October 20 - Dussehra	October 08 – October 15 October 25 – November 01

BANGLADESH	
BANK HOLIDAYS	DELIVERY TIDES
20–21 October 2026 – Durga Puja	October 09 – October 12 October 25 – October 28

BANK HOLIDAYS	
PAKISTAN	TURKEY
November 09 – Allama Iqbal Day	28–29 October 2026 – Republic Day

Prices indicated above are as reported in the market and are not necessarily accurate. This information is provided without prejudice and is given in good faith and without any guarantees whatsoever. While every care has been taken in the preparation of this report, no liability can be accepted for any loss incurred in any way whatsoever by any person relying on the information contained herein. Opinions expressed herein may be deemed subjective and arbitrary. This WEEKLY is intended only for the person or entity to which it is addressed and may contain confidential and/or privileged material. Any review, retransmission, dissemination, or other use of this information by persons or entities other than the intended recipient is prohibited.

ALANG - Port Position as of October 09, 2026

No.	VESSEL NAME	LDT	TYPE	STATUS
1	EVS	1,226	Fishing	<i>Delivered October 09</i>
2	Right	10,068	Oil Tanker	<i>Delivered October 07</i>
3	Enisey	9,886	Bulk Carrier	Delivered October 06

CHATTOGRAM - Port Position as of October 09, 2026

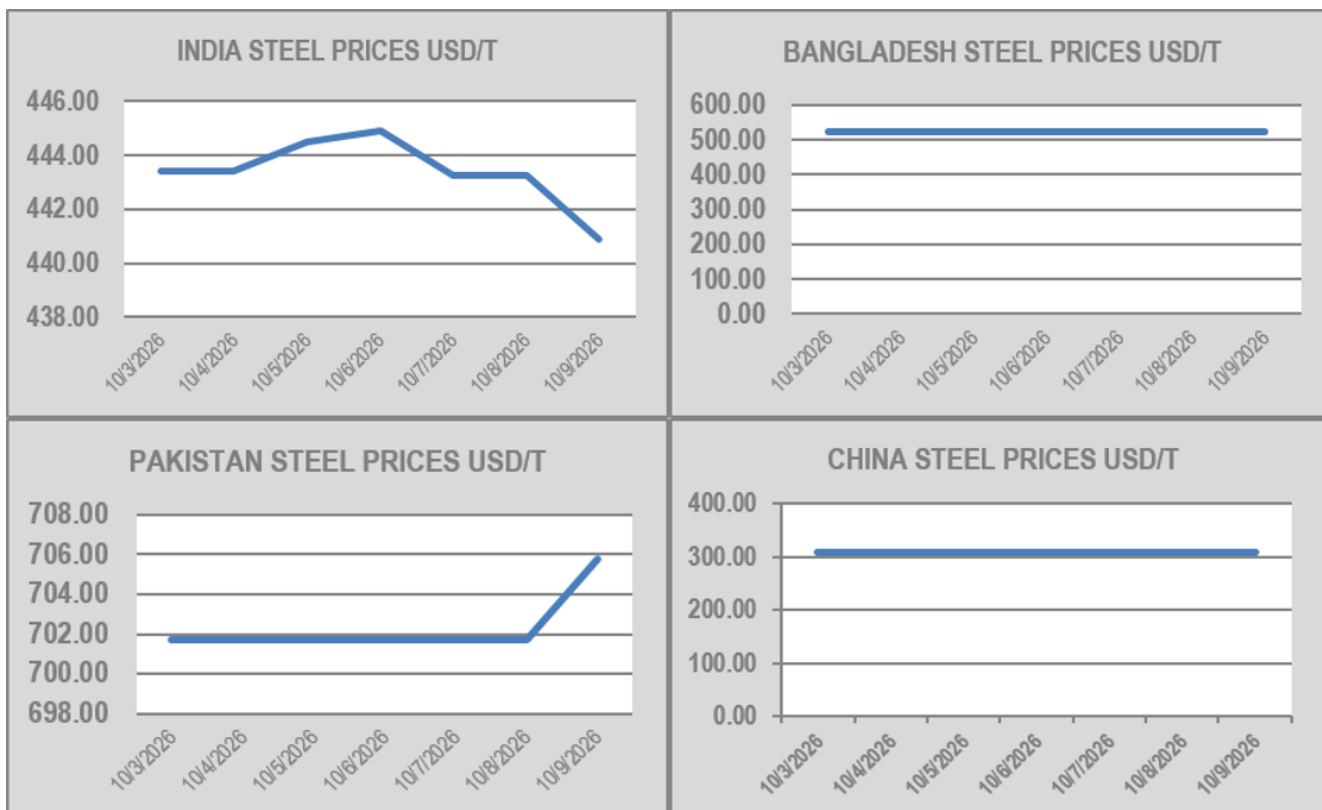
No.	VESSEL NAME	LDT	TYPE	STATUS
1	Petrova	2,398	Tanker	<i>Delivered October 09</i>
2	Pacific Leader	911	General Cargo	Delivered October 06
3	Haku	11,304	Ro-Ro Ship	<i>Delivered October 03</i>
4	Merc	490	Tug	<i>Delivered October 02</i>
5	Phil	3,544	Barge	<i>Delivered October 02</i>
6	B-LPG Sophia (D/VSL)	3,421	LPG Tanker	Arrived September 28

GADANI - Port Position as of October 09, 2026

No.	VESSEL NAME	LDT	TYPE	STATUS
1	Lina F	5,688	Bulk Carrier	<i>Delivered October 02</i>
2	Portland 11	7,381	Bulk Carrier	Arrived September 28
3	Maestro	5,143	Bulk Carrier	Arrived September 24

WHILE EXTREME CARE HAS BEEN TAKEN IN THE PREPARATION OF THIS REPORT, NO LIABILITY CAN BE ACCEPTED FOR ANY LOSS INCURRED IN ANY WAY WHATSOEVER BY ANY PERSON RELYING ON THE INFORMATION CONTAINED HEREIN.

DATE	INDIA STEEL PRICES USD/T	INDIA STEEL PRICES	PAKISTAN STEEL PRICES USD/T	PAKISTAN STEEL PRICES	BANGLADESH STEEL PRICES USD/T	BANGLADESH STEEL PRICES	CHINA STEEL PRICES USD/T
10/3/2026	443.41	42,700.00	701.69	195,000.00	522.24	64,000.00	309.46
10/4/2026	443.41	42,700.00	701.69	195,000.00	522.24	64,000.00	309.46
10/5/2026	444.49	42,800.00	701.69	195,000.00	522.24	64,000.00	309.46
10/6/2026	444.93	42,900.00	701.69	195,000.00	522.24	64,000.00	309.46
10/7/2026	443.27	42,900.00	701.69	195,000.00	522.24	64,000.00	309.46
10/8/2026	443.27	42,900.00	701.69	195,000.00	522.24	64,000.00	309.46
10/9/2026	440.90	42,600.00	705.80	196,000.00	522.24	64,000.00	309.46



www.gmsinc.net



GMS_Leadership



GMS Leadership



snp@gmsinc.net

Athens, Greece Tel: +30.210.899.0669
Cumberland, USA Tel: +1.301.759.9240
Hamburg, Germany Tel: +49.40. 3197.9963
Shanghai, China Tel: +86.216.075.1900
Singapore Tel: +65.6823.8037

Bhavnagar, India Tel: +91.278.300.5253
Dubai, UAE Tel: +971.4.423.0720
New York, USA: +1.240.505.9716
Seoul, South Korea Tel: +82.10.4650.0720
Tokyo, Japan Tel: +81.3.5453.6311